

AGREEMENT

BETWEEN

The Board of Education

School District No. 15

Clinton, Illinois

and

The Clinton Education Association

Beginning

August 15, 2025

Through

August 2027

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ARTICLE I
RECOGNITION

- A. The Board of Education of District 15, DeWitt County, Clinton, Illinois, hereinafter referred to as the “Board,” hereby recognizes the Clinton Education Association, hereinafter referred to as the “Association” affiliated with the Illinois Education Association and the National Education Association, as the exclusive and sole negotiation agent for all regularly employed certificated teaching personnel except the superintendent, unit office personnel, principals, assistant principals, and administrative assistants (serving in administrative capacity 50% of their time.)
- B. The term “teacher,” when used hereinafter in this agreement, shall refer to all certified employees represented by the Association in the negotiating unit as determined in paragraph A above.
- C. The Board agrees not to negotiate with any teachers’ organization other than the Association for the duration of this agreement; further, the Board agrees not to negotiate with any teacher individually during the duration of this agreement on matters subject to negotiations. The Board reserves the right to counsel or confer with any teacher in an informal manner.

ARTICLE II
MAINTENANCE OF STANDARDS

When the classroom duties of any teacher are substantially altered or increased without prior notification and are not an acceptable change, the teacher or Association may start grievance procedures.

ARTICLE III
BOARD RIGHTS

The Board shall not be required to bargain over inherent managerial policy which shall include the following areas of discretion or policy:

1. The function of the Board.
2. Standard of Service.
3. The Board's overall budget.
4. Selection of new employees.
5. Direction of all employees.

ARTICLE IV
ASSOCIATION AND TEACHERS' RIGHTS

- A. Teachers shall have the right to organize, join and assist the Association to participate in professional negotiations with the Board through representatives of their own choosing, and to engage in other legal activities individually or in concert for the purpose of establishing, maintaining, protecting or improving conditions of professional service in the educational program. The teacher has the right not to be represented by any organization.
- B. Nothing contained herein shall be construed to deny any teacher rights he/she may have under the School Code of the State of Illinois or under other applicable laws and regulations.
- C. As a duly elected body exercising governmental power under the laws of the State of Illinois, the Board shall not discourage directly or indirectly or deprive any teacher his/her rights in the enjoyment of any rights conferred by the laws of Illinois or the Constitution of the State of Illinois or the Constitution of the United States, and that it will continue not to discriminate against any teacher with respect to hours, wages, terms or conditions of employment by reason of his/her membership in the Association or in negotiations with the Board, or to discriminate against any teacher in his/her institution of any grievance complaint or procedure under this agreement.
- D. Rules and regulations governing teacher conduct shall be reasonable, and the enforcement of teacher discipline (which includes suspension) shall be impartial, factual and for reasons which are just. If a teacher is released from an extracurricular position other than that of department head, the release can be contested and processed only through Step 4 of the Professional Grievance Procedure (Article XVI).
- E. The Board shall not renew individual teacher contracts or employment agreements during negotiations, mediation, fact finding, or before agreement has been reached between the Board and the Association. The board may, however, issue individual contracts to newly employed teachers and non tenure teachers during this time.
- F. The Board shall place on the agenda of each regular Board meeting any matters requested by the Association, so long as these matters are made known in writing or electronically to the Superintendent one week prior to the regular meeting.

The President of the Association or his/her designee shall be given a written or provided an electronic copy of the agenda at least 48 hours prior to the scheduled time of each regular meeting of the Board, and a verbal notice and its purpose 12 hours prior to each special meeting.

- G. Board minutes shall be posted as soon as they have been prepared. The Association will provide to the Superintendent at the beginning of the school year the date and place of all scheduled Association meetings. Every effort will be made to notify the Superintendent of special meetings forty-eight (48) hours in advance.
- H. The Board shall make available, upon request, to the Association, annual financial reports and audits, a list of names and addresses of teachers, tentative budgetary requirements and allocations, treasurer's reports, census and pupil membership data and all other information which will assist the Association in developing intelligent, accurate, informed and constructive programs on behalf of the teachers and their pupils.

- I. The Association and its representatives shall have access to school buildings for meetings and to transact official Association business on school property at all reasonable times, provided that such business does not interfere with or interrupt normal school operations. The standard building use procedure shall be followed.
- J. The Board shall provide a bulletin board designated by the principal for the exclusive use of the Association in each school building for posting notices of activities and other matters of Association concern. The regular district mail service shall be made available to the Association for communications to teachers. Any notices or materials regarding political and/or private enterprise information shall be identified as CEA/IEA communications.
- K. The Association shall have the use of school equipment and facility at reasonable times when such equipment/facility is not otherwise in use. The district agrees to provide the Master Contract electronically.
- L. The Association's and Board of Education's views on matters relating to supervisor-teacher or Board-teacher relationship shall not be discussed in the presence of students.
- M. When any teacher is required to appear before the Board concerning any matter which would adversely affect the continuation of that teacher in his/her office, position of employment, the salary, or any increments pertaining thereto, the teacher shall be given reasonable prior notice of the reasons for such meeting or interview and shall be entitled to have a representative of the Association present to advise him/her and represent him/her during such meeting or interview.
- N. Each teacher shall have the right, upon request, to review the contents of his/her own personnel file. A representative of the Association may, at the teacher's request, accompany the teacher in this review. Teaching credentials are an exception to the above. Whenever an administrator places a letter of reprimand or suspension in a teacher's personnel file, the teacher shall be provided a copy of the letter of reprimand or suspension prior to or at the time the letter is placed in his/her file.
- O. Teachers may have permission to leave the building to conduct association or other professional duties during student non-contact time—provided advance notice is given to the building principal or his/her designee.
- P. Any teacher who is a member, or who has applied for membership may sign an authorization for payroll deduction of the membership dues in the Association, the IEA and NEA. Authorization forms will be collected each year by the Association and delivered to the Business Office no later than August 31. The Board shall each month deduct one-sixteenth (1/16) of such dues from the salary check of the teacher with first deduction September 10 and the final deduction April 25.
- Q. With respect to all sums deducted by the Board pursuant to authorization of the employees for membership dues, the Board shall remit promptly to the treasurer of the Association that amount withheld.
- R. Each group shall distribute copies of the Master Contract to its own members.
- S. The rights granted herein to the Association shall not be granted or extended to any competing teacher organization.
- T. The provisions of the Agreement shall not be applied in a manner which is arbitrary, capricious or discriminatory.

- U. The name of Clinton Community Unit No. 15 shall not be used by any vendors or organizations for making profit.
- V. Administrators shall attempt to assign teachers to committees of their interest. Teachers will be expected to serve on committees. Every effort shall be made to avoid transferring a teacher from one committee to another until the objectives have been attained. No teacher will be required to serve on more than one (1) district-wide study committee during a school year.
- W. Teachers shall dress in a manner befitting their profession.
- X. Membership in the teachers' association or any other organization will be on a voluntary basis. The Association agrees that there will be no intimidation or harassment of staff eligible for bargaining unit membership.
- Y. Teachers will have readily available a substitute folder and lesson plans for use by the substitute.
- Z. The duty day will be from 7:45 a.m. to 3:30 p.m., except on days preceding holidays and vacations the teacher's day shall end at the close of the pupil's day. Teachers shall be expected to attend faculty meetings as called by the building principal. The teacher work day, with the approval of the administration, may be changed to accommodate zero hour classes or after my school classes in order to meet the needs of students. Assignments of zero hour classes or after school classes shall be made only on a voluntary basis.

It is recognized that occasionally time is required for meetings between the Administration and Staff. Sometimes these meetings may need to extend beyond the contractual work school day. Required, but uncompensated time beyond the contractual day, will not exceed fifteen (15) hours per school year. Every effort will be made to create a master calendar by the end of August of each school year in consultation with the Association which will provide advance notice of scheduled dates and times. If changes need to be made to the fifteen (15) hours, there shall be a thirty (30) day notice, unless otherwise agreed to by the Superintendent and Association President. Nothing herein shall apply to the need to call an emergency staff meeting for extenuating circumstances.

- AA. Teachers are encouraged to attend school functions.
- BB. All Clinton Education Association meetings will be held after the end of the regular student school day.
- CC. The Clinton Education Association shall be given twenty (20) days per year for the Association President or his/her designee to conduct association business. The leave days will not be charged against personal or professional leave, nor will the teacher(s) suffer any loss of salary. The use of the leave shall not impair the quality of classroom instruction. The Association shall notify the Superintendent in writing at least five (5) days in advance of the use of the leave except in the case of an emergency. No more than two (2) teachers may use the leave on the same day. The CEA will reimburse the district for the cost of the substitute(s).
- DD. Changes in student grades shall be made in accordance with the provisions outlined in the Grading Procedure policy. Changes in this policy shall be made only with the mutual written consent of the Association and the Board.

- EE. In the event that a teacher is absent from school for any unauthorized time, other than for the reason of inclement weather road conditions, a salary deduction is to be made from the following month's check and such is based on a school year of 180 days (190 days for two weeks extended employment, 200 days for 10-month contract, 225 days for an 11-month contract.)
- FF. Teachers must notify the office when work can be resumed after an extended absence (3 consecutive days). If a teacher fails in this responsibility and thereby causes the district to employ a substitute who reports for duty, the following actions will be taken:
1. The substitute teacher will be paid, and
 2. The regular teacher will be docked the cost of the substitute teacher, and
 3. The regular teacher will assume control of the classroom on the day in question.
- GG. In order to maintain a quality educational program and continuity of instruction, in case of prolonged absence of a teacher, whenever possible the same substitute will remain in charge of the class until the regular teacher returns.
- HH. Teacher dismissal shall follow procedure as outlined in Article 24-12 in the School Code of Illinois.
- II. If reduction in force becomes necessary, the reduction of teaching personnel will be done in accordance with the following procedures:
1. Notice of such reductions shall be given to the Teacher by regular mail, and certified mail or personal delivery with receipt at least 45 days before the end of the school term;
 2. Each Teacher must be categorized into one or more positions for which the Teacher is qualified to hold, based upon legal qualifications and any other qualifications established in a job description, on or before May 10 prior to the school year during which the sequence of dismissal is determined. Within each position, the school district must establish 4 groupings (as established by statute) of Teachers qualified to hold the position;
 3. Among Teachers qualified to hold a position, Teachers must be dismissed in the order of their Groupings, with Teachers in Grouping 1 dismissed first and Teachers in Grouping 4 dismissed last. Within each Grouping, the sequence of dismissal is established by statute;
 4. If the Board has any vacancies for the following school term or within one (1) calendar year from the beginning of the following school term, the positions thereby becoming available shall be tendered to the Teachers within Grouping 3 or Grouping 4 so removed or dismissed so far as they are legally qualified to hold such positions; and
 5. Any Teacher removed or dismissed through the above-mentioned reduction in force procedure and who accepts the tender of a vacancy within one (1) calendar year from the beginning of the following school term shall lose no rights which accrued while in contractual service.
- JJ. The observation and evaluation of teachers will follow procedure as outlined in Board policy. A copy of Board policy 5:202 on evaluation for the current school year will be in the Teacher Manual which is distributed to each teacher at the beginning of the school year.

- KK. Academic freedom is a desired goal of District #15 in order to provide an opportunity for the classroom atmosphere to be void of partisanship and bias. While recognizing that the teacher has a primary obligation for the instruction of students, it is agreed that the staff will work in full cooperation with the Board and Administration to have a balanced and free presentation of facts and ideas concerning man, society, the physical and biological world and other branches of learning.
- LL. The Board shall indemnify and protect teachers as prescribed by law. (Section 10-20.20 of the School Code of Illinois.)
- MM. Any case of assault upon a teacher shall be promptly reported to the Board by the teacher and/or the Administration. The Board shall provide the advice of its legal counsel to the teacher in order to advise the teacher of all rights and obligations with respect to the assault.

ARTICLE V
TEACHING HOURS AND ASSIGNMENTS

- A. Reorganization of the instructional responsibilities within a building is to be permitted and encouraged in order to best utilize the teaching staff. Such organization shall be a cooperative venture between the teachers, but will be placed in effect only upon approval of the building administrator. None of the foregoing shall violate the terms of the contract.
- B. Maximum limits for teacher load shall take into account the type of teaching needed to give students high quality instruction in each of the various subject fields.
- C. The recommendations for limits of teacher load shall consist of the best professional knowledge as to desirable teacher load.
- D. A classroom teacher may be assigned no more than 29 contact hours per week. Contact hours are defined as any time when teachers could be assigned duties.
- E. New teachers employed by the Board for a regular teaching assignment shall have at least a baccalaureate degree from an accredited college or university and a valid teaching license.
- F. A teacher shall not be required to work under unsafe or hazardous conditions or to perform tasks which endanger his/her health, safety or well-being.
- G. Any assignments in addition to the normal teaching schedule, including but not limited to adult education courses, extra duties enumerated in the contract (except the assignable supervisory duties as noted below), and summer school courses shall not be obligatory, but shall be with the consent of the teacher. Teachers will be offered assignments based on competency, qualifications, and experience. If the assignable supervisory duties/activities set forth in this contract cannot be filled by a voluntary basis, the administration reserves the right to assign a teacher to these duties/activities.
- H. Positions in the summer school program shall, to the extent feasible, be filled by regularly appointed teachers in the school district. In filling such positions, consideration shall be given to a teacher's competence, major and minor field of study and length of service in the school district.
- I. In the case of extreme cold, extreme heat, and/or building utilities not working properly, the building principal will notify the Superintendent and every attempt will be made to dismiss school or to reassign the students and the teacher to a more satisfying area.
- J. If a teacher fails to report to work on an attendance day or institute day due to inclement weather and/or poor road conditions, he/she will be docked an amount equal to the cost of a substitute. In case roads are officially closed he/she will only be charged a personal day.
- K. Any teacher who is asked by the administrator to cover a class other than his/her own for a minimum time of twenty minutes will be informed that compensation is available at a rate of .090% of the most current fiscal year's base salary per clock hour.

- L. The district will provide a part-time clerical aide for each elementary building and the Junior High School to assist teachers with clerical and other tasks assigned by the building principal. The first priority of these aides is to assist teachers. Each of these aides will be available for fifteen (15) hours per week. Should there be a reduction in force, the Association and Board of Education shall meet to negotiate a Memorandum of Agreement regarding Article VI.L only.
- M. All bargaining members will receive a minimum of thirty continuous minutes of daily planning/preparation time within student hours.
- N. The Board agrees to pay all trained mentors who engage in formal mentoring an annual stipend of \$450.00 per protégé not to exceed two protégés. Every effort will be made to assign only one protégé per mentor.
- Formal Mentor Program: A Formal Mentor will be provided to each brand new teacher (protégé). The mentorship will be a two year period. An Activity Log, along with other documentation as part of the Mentor Program, must be provided to the Mentor Coordinator at the conclusion of each year by the mentor and protégé. If it is mutually agreed upon by the CEA and Administration to change mentors after the first year, the Formal Mentor would only receive \$450. Formal Mentors are paid \$450 each year (\$900 for both years). Stipends for Formal Mentors will be included in a June Payroll.
 - Informal Mentor Program: An Informal Mentor will be provided to each teacher with existing teaching experience. Informal Mentors are not required to complete any documentation. The purpose of an Informal Mentor is to provide the experienced teacher a point-person to assist them, as needed. An Informal Mentor is an unpaid role.
- O. All bargaining members will receive a minimum 30-minute duty-free lunch within the student day.
- P. Teachers will be paid at the rate of .090% of the base salary if the teacher must attend or conduct a meeting or cover duties during their planning time.
- Q. For the students who have minutes legally written in their I.E.P., teachers will be compensated at the hourly rate in the event that the teacher must cover during his/her planning time for the aide(s) absence.
- R. Special Education Teachers will be allotted one (1) release day for each case manager with a caseload of 1-10 students, one (1) additional release day will be allotted for 11-20 students, and an additional one half (1/2) release day will be allotted for each additional five (5) students.
- S. Any and all assignments beyond the school calendar year shall be re-evaluated by the association and district each year through a MOU (memorandum of understanding) by April 1st of each year.

ARTICLE VI
EVALUATION

- A. Non-tenured employees shall be evaluated at least twice in each school term. Tenured employees shall be evaluated according to current law.
- B. At the start of the school term (i.e., the first day students are required to be in attendance), the school district shall provide a written notice that a performance evaluation will be conducted in that school term to each teacher affected or, if the affected teacher is hired after the start of the school term then no later than thirty (30) days after the contract is executed. The building principal or immediate supervisor shall acquaint each employee under said supervisor's supervision with the evaluation procedures, standards and instruments, and the principal or immediate supervisor shall advise each employee as to who will observe and evaluate the employee's performance. No evaluation may take place until such orientation has been completed.
- C. The Board of Education will follow the evaluation procedure for certified staff as outlined in the Teacher's Guidebook for Evaluation. Any changes to said Guidebook will be determined by the PERA joint committee. No teacher may utilize the grievance procedure to challenge any decision of the PERA joint committee or his or her evaluation rating. Only the procedural aspects of the Guidebook may be subject to grievance procedure.
- D. Teacher evaluation shall be done in compliance with Article 24A of the School Code

ARTICLE VII
PERSONAL AND PROFESSIONAL LEAVE

- A. Each teacher shall be granted two (2) work days of personal leave per year, accumulated to five (5) work days. When accumulated five days are unused, the yearly additional days will be added to accumulated sick leave days. The teacher planning to use a personal leave day or days, shall log into the District provided software (i.e. Red Rover) to request a substitute at least one day in advance, except in cases of emergency. Personal leave day(s) can be taken before or after a holiday but not the first and last day of each semester. No more than five (5) teachers district wide may take personal leave on any given day. Exceptions to the above limitations can be made by the superintendent in cases of emergency or when an employee has to move a child or children to a college or university.
- B. Each teacher shall be granted two (2) work days of professional leave per year to attend professional conferences and conventions, in-service meetings, workshops, seminars, etc. All requests for such professional leave must have prior approval of the building principal who will forward the request with his recommendation to the superintendent. If the professional leave is approved, the teacher will log into the district provided software (i.e. Red Rover) to request a substitute.

When a teacher's request for professional leave is approved, the teacher will be charged professional leave, and the district will provide and pay a substitute; or the principal, at his discretion, may choose to send the teacher to the meeting with no charge to professional leave days, and the district will still provide and pay the substitute.

- C. No more than three (3) work days personal and professional leave may be taken consecutively. Requests for personal and professional leave must be in sufficient time to secure a substitute.
- D. The Board of Education may extend personal leave at its discretion.
- E. A teacher serving on a jury or an employee who is subpoenaed to appear in a matter in which said employee is not a party or party of interest, during his/her scheduled working hours, shall receive his/her full salary for the time served on the jury or subpoena to appear in court, surrendering to the employer all payments received for serving as juror or subpoenaed witness less any payments for non-duty days, mileage allowance, meal allowance and parking fees. If such jury service or subpoena to appear in court is for less than half the normal workday, the employee shall return to his/her assigned duty.

ARTICLE VIII

SICK LEAVE

- A. Each school year, teacher(s) will be provided fifteen (15) days sick leave for use. Unused sick leave will accumulate up to four hundred (400) days. It will be the responsibility of the individual teacher to log into the district provided software (i.e. Red Rover) to request a substitute. The teacher will make every effort to request a substitute (via Red Rover) no later than 6:30 AM the day of the needed substitute. It is recognized that occasionally a qualified substitute may not be available or needed. The building principal will make the final determination with regard to qualifications and needs.
- B. In the event that a member of the staff is seriously ill or injured and exhausts his/her accrued sick leave, the Board of Education, after five (5) consecutive days of absence for each illness or occurrence, will review the circumstances, if so requested in writing by the teacher, and as a result of such review, the Board of Education may extend the sick leave benefits. The Board's decision shall not be subject to the Professional Grievance Procedure of this contract.
- C. Sick leave is intended to cover the employee in the event of personal illness, quarantine at home, serious illness, or death in the immediate family or household, birth/pregnancy, adoption, and/or process of adoption. Immediate family shall include parents, spouse, domestic partner, brothers, sisters, children, grandparents, grandchildren, parents-in-law, sisters-in-law, brothers-in-law, and legal guardians.
1. The following shall be considered sick leave:
 - a. Personal illness.
 - b. Family quarantine.
 - c. Serious illness of immediate family.
 - d. Illness of small children in household.
 - e. Death in immediate family.
 - f. Funerals (other than e) properly cleared in advance.
 - g. It is realized that all instances cannot be covered. In those cases, not covered above, clarification shall be made to the Superintendent of Schools in advance.
 2. The Board may require a physician's examination and report certifying illness and/or disability and specifying the time period. If the Board requests the physician's report, the Board will assume the cost.
 3. Attendance bonus: Any employee that does not use any of his/her sick days in a given semester will receive an incentive bonus in the following manner:

Zero days absent =\$250 per semester

1-2 days absent=\$150 per semester

The aforementioned bonus shall be paid at the last regular paycheck. For a teacher receiving salary increases as defined in Article XIV C(11), the attendance incentive bonus will be paid as a post-retirement bonus. The post-retirement bonus shall not be due or paid until after the teacher's receipt of his/her final regular paycheck.

4. BEREAVEMENT: Employees may use up to three (3) days per incident for leave connected with death in the immediate family. Immediate family shall include parents, spouse, domestic partner, brothers, sisters, children, grandparents, grandchildren, parents-in-law, sisters-in-law, brothers-in-law, step children, and legal guardians. Teachers may use one (1) day per incident for funeral attendance of an aunt, uncle, niece, or nephew. Such leave shall be a non-cumulative per incident allowance granted prior to the deduction of any sick leave.

ARTICLE IX
LEAVES OF ABSENCE

A. General Rules for Leaves.

The following conditions shall apply to all extended leaves of absence:

1. Before a teacher submits a written request for any leave to the Superintendent, the teacher will first discuss such a request with the building principal. Such requests should, when possible, be submitted at least sixty (60) days prior to the effective date.
2. Eligibility, except for leaves covered under the Family & Medical Leave Policy, shall be based on a minimum of two (2) years of continuous employment in the Clinton District. Maternity leave can be granted during any year of employment. Maternity leave shall be granted upon proof of formal adoption of a child or preschool age as well as childbirth.
3. All leaves shall be limited to one (1) year effective as of the date of the leave. Further extension shall be at the discretion of the Board.
4. Written notice of intention to either return or resign shall, when possible, be given to the Superintendent at least sixty (60) calendar days prior to the expiration of the leave. Failure to furnish such written notice shall constitute a notice of resignation.
5. Re-employment during the school year shall be at the discretion of the Board of Education. Staff members who are granted leaves of absence cannot be assured of placement in the same position when they return. The best possible assignment, however, shall be made within the existing vacancies.
6. Any benefits covered under the provisions of the Agreement shall be suspended during the leave of absence except for the portion of the leave that is approved as a part of the Family and Medical Leave Act. All benefits accrued prior to the leave of absence shall be reinstated upon return of the teacher. Accrued benefits shall be defined to mean tenure status, accumulated sick leave, placement on salary schedule, and accumulated leave days.
7. Any teacher who has completed two-thirds (2/3) or more of the term prior to his/her leave shall be considered to have completed a full year for purposes of advancement on the salary schedule.
8. The Board may require a physician's examination and report prior to the return of a teacher who has been on a leave of absence.

ARTICLE X
VACANCIES AND TRANSFERS

A. Assignment and Transfer.

Teacher's requests for transfer to another teaching assignment within the school district will be handled as follows:

1. Teachers are required to discuss requests for transfers with their building principals before submitting such requests in writing.
2. Requests for transfer of teaching assignments for teachers will be directed, in writing, to the building principal who will then forward them to the Superintendent for review.
3. In evaluating such requests, the welfare of the school district will be considered along with the qualification of the applicant.
4. When such requests are properly received, decisions relative to the request will be forwarded to the applicant, in writing, whether his/her request is granted or denied.
5. Appeals from such decisions will be filed, in writing, with the Superintendent of Schools who will arrange for a review of the request and the decision by the Board of Education.

B. Vacancies and Transfers.

1. The District Office shall post and send an email to all staff notice of all bargaining unit vacancies including teaching and extra duty positions and vacancies in administrative positions, as they occur. No vacancy, except in cases of emergency, shall be filled until such vacancy shall have been posted for at least seven (7) calendar days. If the Superintendent deems that a state of emergency exists, the notice of the vacancy will indicate that the position will be filled as soon as possible. Notwithstanding any other provision herein, the Board shall fill any vacant teaching position based upon the consideration of factors that include without limitation: certifications, qualifications, merit and ability (including performance evaluations, if available), and relevant experience, provided that the length of continuing service with the school district will not be considered as a factor, unless all other factors are determined by the Board to be equal. The Board's decision to select a particular candidate to fill a vacant teaching position shall not be subject to review under the grievance procedure contained herein; provided that in making such a decision, the Board does not fail to adhere to procedural requirements contained herein.
2. Any teacher qualified for a vacancy may apply for transfer to another building where a vacancy exists. Such a request shall be in writing to the building principal. Reasons for denial will be given.
3. Involuntary transfers that result in relocating a teacher to another building or in reassigning a teacher and result in changing the teacher's immediate supervisor shall be made only after due consideration is given to the qualifications of the teacher and the merits of the transfer. When it is necessary to involuntarily transfer a teacher to another building, all volunteers shall be considered. The final decision regarding an involuntary transfer rests with the administration. Such a transfer shall be made in the best interest of the educational program.

4. Any teacher affected by an involuntary transfer shall be notified at least 40 calendar days prior to the initiation of his/her assignment and may be released by the Board from his/her contract if he/she requests. Any teacher transferred involuntarily due solely to space, enrollment and/or budgetary consideration shall receive priority consideration for any subsequent vacancies for which he/she applies and is qualified.

ARTICLE XI
EQUIPMENT, SUPPLIES AND FACILITIES

Every effort will be made to provide the time, materials, equipment, and space necessary to do the tasks assigned to a teacher.

The BOARD shall provide:

1. Typing and duplicating facilities in each school.
2. Suitable space for each teacher to store coats, overshoes, and personal articles.
3. One copy, exclusively for each teacher's use, of each text and supplementary materials used in each of the courses he/she is to teach.
4. A teachers' lounge, which is comfortably furnished and cleaned daily, in each building.
5. Telephone facilities for teachers' reasonable use, for local calls only.

ARTICLE XII
CLASS SIZE

Realizing that class size is important in the instructional program, every effort will be made to maintain educationally acceptable class sizes in Kindergarten through 5th grade (K-5). It is the goal of the District and Union to keep the average class sizes not to exceed twenty three (23) for Kindergarten through 2nd Grade and twenty five (25) for 3rd through 5th Grade.

ARTICLE XIII
DISTRICT LEADERSHIP TEAM

The District shall have a District Leadership Team. The Committee will consist of:

- One (1) teacher from each building to be selected by the Superintendent from each building's leadership team;
- President of the Clinton Education Association; and
- Such other members as deemed necessary by the Superintendent.

Any teacher required in writing to work beyond the work day shall be compensated at the hourly rate as specified in the CBA. The focus of this Team is to study and implement educational initiatives District wide.

ARTICLE XIV
COMPENSATION AND FRINGE BENEFITS

A. TEACHERS' SALARY SCHEDULES

2025-2026 Salary Schedule (With TRS Included)

NOTE: The figures below INCLUDE the 4.5% TRS board paid contribution with a Base Salary of \$44,500. The exact percentage that will be used to determine the TRS board contribution will be based on the TRS Employer Guide, (Chapter 3 "Creditable Earnings"), specifically the "Table of Factors".

STEP	BA-0	BA-8	BA-16	BA-24	MA-0	MA-8	MA-16	MA-24	MA-32	MA-40	MA-48
0	46,503	47,502	48,524	49,567	50,633	51,721	52,833	53,969	55,129	56,315	57,525
1	47,502	48,524	49,567	50,633	51,721	52,833	53,969	55,129	56,315	57,525	58,762
2	48,524	49,567	50,633	51,721	52,833	53,969	55,129	56,315	57,525	58,762	60,026
3	49,567	50,633	51,721	52,833	53,969	55,129	56,315	57,525	58,762	60,026	61,316
4	50,633	51,721	52,833	53,969	55,129	56,315	57,525	58,762	60,026	61,316	62,634
5	51,721	52,833	53,969	55,129	56,315	57,525	58,762	60,026	61,316	62,634	63,981
6	52,833	53,969	55,129	56,315	57,525	58,762	60,026	61,316	62,634	63,981	65,357
7	53,969	55,129	56,315	57,525	58,762	60,026	61,316	62,634	63,981	65,357	66,762
8	55,129	56,315	57,525	58,762	60,026	61,316	62,634	63,981	65,357	66,762	68,197
9	56,315	57,525	58,762	60,026	61,316	62,634	63,981	65,357	66,762	68,197	69,664
10	57,525	58,762	60,026	61,316	62,634	63,981	65,357	66,762	68,197	69,664	71,161
11	58,762	60,026	61,316	62,634	63,981	65,357	66,762	68,197	69,664	71,161	72,691
12	60,026	61,316	62,634	63,981	65,357	66,762	68,197	69,664	71,161	72,691	74,254
13	61,316	62,634	63,981	65,357	66,762	68,197	69,664	71,161	72,691	74,254	75,851
14	62,634	63,981	65,357	66,762	68,197	69,664	71,161	72,691	74,254	75,851	77,481
15	63,981	65,357	66,762	68,197	69,664	71,161	72,691	74,254	75,851	77,481	79,147
16	65,357	66,762	68,197	69,664	71,161	72,691	74,254	75,851	77,481	79,147	80,849
17	66,762	68,197	69,664	71,161	72,691	74,254	75,851	77,481	79,147	80,849	82,587
18	68,197	69,664	71,161	72,691	74,254	75,851	77,481	79,147	80,849	82,587	84,363
19	69,664	71,161	72,691	74,254	75,851	77,481	79,147	80,849	82,587	84,363	86,177
20	71,161	72,691	74,254	75,851	77,481	79,147	80,849	82,587	84,363	86,177	88,029
21		74,254	75,851	77,481	79,147	80,849	82,587	84,363	86,177	88,029	89,922
22		75,851	77,481	79,147	80,849	82,587	84,363	86,177	88,029	89,922	91,855
23			79,147	80,849	82,587	84,363	86,177	88,029	89,922	91,855	93,830
24				82,587	84,363	86,177	88,029	89,922	91,855	93,830	95,848
25				84,363	86,177	88,029	89,922	91,855	93,830	95,848	97,908
26					88,029	89,922	91,855	93,830	95,848	97,908	100,013
27					89,922	91,855	93,830	95,848	97,908	100,013	102,164
28					91,855	93,830	95,848	97,908	100,013	102,164	104,360
29						95,848	97,908	100,013	102,164	104,360	106,604
30						97,908	100,013	102,164	104,360	106,604	108,896
31								104,360	106,604	108,896	111,237

Any new employee will be placed on the salary schedule based on the number of years in public education and number of hours beyond their Bachelor's degree. Notification shall be given to the Association prior to Board approval. The notification shall include the name, years of experience, and placement on the salary schedule. Teachers may only move one horizontal lane per year; for example, moving from Lane BA-0 to BA-8. Teachers cannot move multiple lanes; for example, moving from Lane BA-0 to BA-16.

NOTE: The figures DO NOT INCLUDE the 4.5% TRS board paid contribution with a Base Salary of \$44,500.

STEP	BA-0	BA-8	BA-16	BA-24	MA-0	MA-8	MA-16	MA-24	MA-32	MA-40	MA-48
0	44,500	45,457	46,434	47,432	48,452	49,494	50,558	51,645	52,755	53,890	55,048
1	45,457	46,434	47,432	48,452	49,494	50,558	51,645	52,755	53,890	55,048	56,232
2	46,434	47,432	48,452	49,494	50,558	51,645	52,755	53,890	55,048	56,232	57,441
3	47,432	48,452	49,494	50,558	51,645	52,755	53,890	55,048	56,232	57,441	58,676
4	48,452	49,494	50,558	51,645	52,755	53,890	55,048	56,232	57,441	58,676	59,937
5	49,494	50,558	51,645	52,755	53,890	55,048	56,232	57,441	58,676	59,937	61,226
6	50,558	51,645	52,755	53,890	55,048	56,232	57,441	58,676	59,937	61,226	62,542
7	51,645	52,755	53,890	55,048	56,232	57,441	58,676	59,937	61,226	62,542	63,887
8	52,755	53,890	55,048	56,232	57,441	58,676	59,937	61,226	62,542	63,887	65,261
9	53,890	55,048	56,232	57,441	58,676	59,937	61,226	62,542	63,887	65,261	66,664
10	55,048	56,232	57,441	58,676	59,937	61,226	62,542	63,887	65,261	66,664	68,097
11	56,232	57,441	58,676	59,937	61,226	62,542	63,887	65,261	66,664	68,097	69,561
12	57,441	58,676	59,937	61,226	62,542	63,887	65,261	66,664	68,097	69,561	71,057
13	58,676	59,937	61,226	62,542	63,887	65,261	66,664	68,097	69,561	71,057	72,584
14	59,937	61,226	62,542	63,887	65,261	66,664	68,097	69,561	71,057	72,584	74,145
15	61,226	62,542	63,887	65,261	66,664	68,097	69,561	71,057	72,584	74,145	75,739
16	62,542	63,887	65,261	66,664	68,097	69,561	71,057	72,584	74,145	75,739	77,367
17	63,887	65,261	66,664	68,097	69,561	71,057	72,584	74,145	75,739	77,367	79,031
18	65,261	66,664	68,097	69,561	71,057	72,584	74,145	75,739	77,367	79,031	80,730
19	66,664	68,097	69,561	71,057	72,584	74,145	75,739	77,367	79,031	80,730	82,466
20	68,097	69,561	71,057	72,584	74,145	75,739	77,367	79,031	80,730	82,466	84,239
21		71,057	72,584	74,145	75,739	77,367	79,031	80,730	82,466	84,239	86,050
22		72,584	74,145	75,739	77,367	79,031	80,730	82,466	84,239	86,050	87,900
23			75,739	77,367	79,031	80,730	82,466	84,239	86,050	87,900	89,790
24				79,031	80,730	82,466	84,239	86,050	87,900	89,790	91,720
25				80,730	82,466	84,239	86,050	87,900	89,790	91,720	93,692
26					84,239	86,050	87,900	89,790	91,720	93,692	95,706
27					86,050	87,900	89,790	91,720	93,692	95,706	97,764
28					87,900	89,790	91,720	93,692	95,706	97,764	99,866
29						91,720	93,692	95,706	97,764	99,866	102,013
30						93,692	95,706	97,764	99,866	102,013	104,207
31								99,866	102,013	104,207	106,447

2026-2027 Salary Schedule (With TRS Included)

NOTE: The figures below INCLUDE the 5.0% TRS board paid contribution with a Base Salary of \$45,500. The exact percentage that will be used to determine the TRS board contribution will be based on the TRS Employer Guide, (Chapter 3 “Creditable Earnings”), specifically the “Table of Factors”.

STEP	BA-0	BA-8	BA-16	BA-24	MA-0	MA-8	MA-16	MA-24	MA-32	MA-40	MA-48
0	47,775	48,802	49,851	50,923	52,018	53,136	54,279	55,446	56,638	57,856	59,100
1	48,802	49,851	50,923	52,018	53,136	54,279	55,446	56,638	57,856	59,100	60,370
2	49,851	50,923	52,018	53,136	54,279	55,446	56,638	57,856	59,100	60,370	61,668
3	50,923	52,018	53,136	54,279	55,446	56,638	57,856	59,100	60,370	61,668	62,994
4	52,018	53,136	54,279	55,446	56,638	57,856	59,100	60,370	61,668	62,994	64,348
5	53,136	54,279	55,446	56,638	57,856	59,100	60,370	61,668	62,994	64,348	65,732
6	54,279	55,446	56,638	57,856	59,100	60,370	61,668	62,994	64,348	65,732	67,145
7	55,446	56,638	57,856	59,100	60,370	61,668	62,994	64,348	65,732	67,145	68,589
8	56,638	57,856	59,100	60,370	61,668	62,994	64,348	65,732	67,145	68,589	70,063
9	57,856	59,100	60,370	61,668	62,994	64,348	65,732	67,145	68,589	70,063	71,570
10	59,100	60,370	61,668	62,994	64,348	65,732	67,145	68,589	70,063	71,570	73,109
11	60,370	61,668	62,994	64,348	65,732	67,145	68,589	70,063	71,570	73,109	74,680
12	61,668	62,994	64,348	65,732	67,145	68,589	70,063	71,570	73,109	74,680	76,286
13	62,994	64,348	65,732	67,145	68,589	70,063	71,570	73,109	74,680	76,286	77,926
14	64,348	65,732	67,145	68,589	70,063	71,570	73,109	74,680	76,286	77,926	79,602
15	65,732	67,145	68,589	70,063	71,570	73,109	74,680	76,286	77,926	79,602	81,313
16	67,145	68,589	70,063	71,570	73,109	74,680	76,286	77,926	79,602	81,313	83,061
17	68,589	70,063	71,570	73,109	74,680	76,286	77,926	79,602	81,313	83,061	84,847
18	70,063	71,570	73,109	74,680	76,286	77,926	79,602	81,313	83,061	84,847	86,671
19	71,570	73,109	74,680	76,286	77,926	79,602	81,313	83,061	84,847	86,671	88,535
20	73,109	74,680	76,286	77,926	79,602	81,313	83,061	84,847	86,671	88,535	90,438
21		76,286	77,926	79,602	81,313	83,061	84,847	86,671	88,535	90,438	92,383
22		77,926	79,602	81,313	83,061	84,847	86,671	88,535	90,438	92,383	94,369
23			81,313	83,061	84,847	86,671	88,535	90,438	92,383	94,369	96,398
24				84,847	86,671	88,535	90,438	92,383	94,369	96,398	98,470
25				86,671	88,535	90,438	92,383	94,369	96,398	98,470	100,587
26					90,438	92,383	94,369	96,398	98,470	100,587	102,750
27					92,383	94,369	96,398	98,470	100,587	102,750	104,959
28					94,369	96,398	98,470	100,587	102,750	104,959	107,216
29						98,470	100,587	102,750	104,959	107,216	109,521
30						100,587	102,750	104,959	107,216	109,521	111,876
31								107,216	109,521	111,876	114,281

Any new employee will be placed on the salary schedule based on the number of years in public education and number of hours beyond their Bachelor's degree. Notification shall be given to the Association prior to Board approval. The notification shall include the name, years of experience, and placement on the salary schedule.

NOTE: The figures DO NOT INCLUDE the 5% TRS board paid contribution with a Base Salary of \$45,500.

STEP	BA-0	BA-8	BA-16	BA-24	MA-0	MA-8	MA-16	MA-24	MA-32	MA-40	MA-48
0	45,500	46,478	47,478	48,498	49,541	50,606	51,694	52,806	53,941	55,101	56,285
1	46,478	47,478	48,498	49,541	50,606	51,694	52,806	53,941	55,101	56,285	57,495
2	47,478	48,498	49,541	50,606	51,694	52,806	53,941	55,101	56,285	57,495	58,732
3	48,498	49,541	50,606	51,694	52,806	53,941	55,101	56,285	57,495	58,732	59,994
4	49,541	50,606	51,694	52,806	53,941	55,101	56,285	57,495	58,732	59,994	61,284
5	50,606	51,694	52,806	53,941	55,101	56,285	57,495	58,732	59,994	61,284	62,602
6	51,694	52,806	53,941	55,101	56,285	57,495	58,732	59,994	61,284	62,602	63,948
7	52,806	53,941	55,101	56,285	57,495	58,732	59,994	61,284	62,602	63,948	65,323
8	53,941	55,101	56,285	57,495	58,732	59,994	61,284	62,602	63,948	65,323	66,727
9	55,101	56,285	57,495	58,732	59,994	61,284	62,602	63,948	65,323	66,727	68,162
10	56,285	57,495	58,732	59,994	61,284	62,602	63,948	65,323	66,727	68,162	69,627
11	57,495	58,732	59,994	61,284	62,602	63,948	65,323	66,727	68,162	69,627	71,124
12	58,732	59,994	61,284	62,602	63,948	65,323	66,727	68,162	69,627	71,124	72,653
13	59,994	61,284	62,602	63,948	65,323	66,727	68,162	69,627	71,124	72,653	74,215
14	61,284	62,602	63,948	65,323	66,727	68,162	69,627	71,124	72,653	74,215	75,811
15	62,602	63,948	65,323	66,727	68,162	69,627	71,124	72,653	74,215	75,811	77,441
16	63,948	65,323	66,727	68,162	69,627	71,124	72,653	74,215	75,811	77,441	79,106
17	65,323	66,727	68,162	69,627	71,124	72,653	74,215	75,811	77,441	79,106	80,807
18	66,727	68,162	69,627	71,124	72,653	74,215	75,811	77,441	79,106	80,807	82,544
19	68,162	69,627	71,124	72,653	74,215	75,811	77,441	79,106	80,807	82,544	84,319
20	69,627	71,124	72,653	74,215	75,811	77,441	79,106	80,807	82,544	84,319	86,132
21		72,653	74,215	75,811	77,441	79,106	80,807	82,544	84,319	86,132	87,983
22		74,215	75,811	77,441	79,106	80,807	82,544	84,319	86,132	87,983	89,875
23			77,441	79,106	80,807	82,544	84,319	86,132	87,983	89,875	91,807
24				80,807	82,544	84,319	86,132	87,983	89,875	91,807	93,781
25				82,544	84,319	86,132	87,983	89,875	91,807	93,781	95,798
26					86,132	87,983	89,875	91,807	93,781	95,798	97,857
27					87,983	89,875	91,807	93,781	95,798	97,857	99,961
28					89,875	91,807	93,781	95,798	97,857	99,961	102,110
29						93,781	95,798	97,857	99,961	102,110	104,306
30						95,798	97,857	99,961	102,110	104,306	106,548
31								102,110	104,306	106,548	108,839

Established experience in public schools, outside this District shall be recognized and credit shall be allowed on the schedule. Private School experience will not be recognized. However, licensed school nurses will receive credit for relevant private and school district experience for placement on the salary schedule. School social workers and speech pathologists employed by the District will be placed on the salary schedule in the MA-32 column and will receive credit for prior relevant experience for placement on the salary schedule.

Part-time teachers will be paid a percentage of the regular salary based upon the percentage of time they spend in a teaching situation. Effective for the first time, beginning with the start of the 1989-1990 school year, teachers employed one-half time and having worked at least two-thirds of a school year will move vertically one step after each school year. Should said teacher be changed to full-time, his/her years' experience will be calculated at 0.5 times the number of years worked in half-time service to the District.

Teachers may only move one horizontal lane per year; for example, moving from Lane BA-0 to BA-8. Teachers cannot move multiple lanes; for example, moving from Lane BA-0 to BA-16.

Teachers will be paid twice monthly on the 10th and 25th of the month with an option to receive their pay over either nine or twelve months. Teachers must elect an option prior to the teacher's first day of service for the school year (first day of work, not the first day of student attendance). The option cannot be changed for the remainder of the school year although it may remain effective from year to year. Teachers who do not submit their choice to the attention of the Business Manager by the deadline shall be paid over nine months. Teachers should keep a record of the notification. It is the responsibility of the administration to explain the process to new teachers when hired into the district. Teachers will be encouraged to use Direct Deposit. All wages received in check form must be picked up in the unit office. Teachers who use direct deposit will be given an electronic remittance of the direct deposit.

B. TRS CONTRIBUTION

Teachers will contribute the required percentage for TRS per current TRS rules of their gross creditable earnings toward their retirement and the current amount per current rules to the Teachers' Health Insurance Security Fund as per Illinois law. Such teacher contributions are included in, and a part of, the above salary schedule. The Board will pay four and half percent (4.5%) towards TRS for the 2025-2026 school year and five percent (5%) towards TRS for the 2026-2027 school year. Further, such teacher contributions are designated as employer contributions and are sheltered from current year income taxes.

According to authority granted by the Pension Reform act of 1974, Section 414 (h) (2) of the Internal Revenue Code, the Board agrees to:

- a. Contribute percentage deemed by current law to the Illinois Teachers' Retirement System and the current amount to the Teachers' Health Insurance Security Fund based on the teacher's yearly salary.
- b. Report as gross income to the Internal Revenue Service the salary, including compensation paid for extracurricular duties or other assignments, less the 9% Board paid contribution to Teachers' Retirement System.
- c. Report as creditable earnings to the Illinois Teachers' Retirement System the amounts shown on the salary schedule plus any additional compensation which qualifies.

- d. Should any of the above be declared improper by an IRS ruling or opinion, that clause or portion thereof shall be deleted from this agreement to the extent that it violates the ruling or opinion.

C. EXTRA DUTY ASSIGNMENTS

The amount to be paid for each additional duty beyond the regular work day which is functioning during this contract will be calculated by multiplying the index with the Bachelor's Degree base salary of \$44,500 for the 2025-2026 school year and \$45,500 2026-2027 school year.

CLINTON SCHOOL DISTRICT ATHLETICS

High School Athletics	Rate	Junior High School Athletics	Rate
Baseball- Head	13%	Baseball- Head	9%
Baseball- Assistant	7%	Baseball- Assistant	6%
Basketball- Head (Boys)	16%	Basketball- Head (Boys)	12%
Basketball- Assistant (Boys)	11%	Basketball- Assistant (7th Grade Boys)	10%
Basketball- Assistant (Boys)	11%	Cross Country- (Boys)	7.50%
Cross Country (Boys)	9%	Cross Country (Girls)	7.50%
Cross Country (Girls)	9%	Track-Head (Boys)	11%
Football- Head	16%	Track-Assistant (Boys)	6.50%
Football- Assistant	11%	Track- Head (Girls)	11%
Football- Assistant	11%	Track-Assistant (Girls)	6.50%
Football- Assistant	11%	Wrestling- Head	12%
Football- Assistant	11%	Wrestling- Assistant	10%
Golf - Head	8%	Basketball- Head (Girls)	12%
Golf- Assistant	1%	Basketball- Assistant (Girls)	10%
Track- Head (Boys)	13%	Volleyball- Head	12%
Track- Assistant (Boys)	7%	Volleyball- Assistant	7%
Track-Assistant (Boys)	7%	Softball- Head	9%
Wrestling- Head (Boys)	16%	Softball- Assistant	6%
Wrestling- Assistant (Boys)	11%		
Wrestling- Head (Girls)	16%	Junior High Club Sponsors	
Basketball- Head (Girls)	16%	Cheerleaders (7th & 8th)	8.50%
Basketball- Assistant (Girls)	11%	Concerts- Instrumental	5%
Track- Head (Girls)	13%	Concerts- Instrumental	5%
Track-Assistant (Girls)	7%	Concerts-Vocal	2.50%
Track-Assistant (Girls)	7%	Concert- Vocal	2.50%
Volleyball- Head	16%	Scholastic Bowl	4%
Volleyball- Assistant	11%	Student Council	5.50%
Volleyball- Assistant	11%	Yearbook	2.50%
Softball- Head	13%	Dance	7.50%

Softball- Assistant	7%	Skills USA	4%
		Leaders's Club	2%
High School Club Sponsors		Department Head - Special Education	4%
Cheerleading	14%	PBIS	4%
Class Sponsor- Freshman	3%	Maroon Buddies	3%
Class Sponsor- Sophomore	3%	FFA (Assistant)	4%
Class Sponsor- Juniors	4%		
Class Sponsor- Seniors	4%	Elementary Extra Duties	
Prom	4%	Elem. Admin. Assistant Douglas	4%
Concerts- Instrumental	5%	Elem. Admin. Assistant Lincoln	4%
Converse- Instrumental	5%	Student Council (grades 2-3)	2%
Concerts- Vocal	2.50%	Student Council (grades 4-5)	2%
Concerts- Vocal	2.50%	Transportation Coord.(Doug, Lin, CES each)	3%
FFA	10%	PBIS- Douglas	4%
FCCLA	2%	MTSS - Douglas	4%
National Honor Society	3%	PBIS- Lincoln	4%
Student Council	6%	MTSS- Lincoln	4%
Yearbook (w/class 5%)	8%	PBIS - CES (2)	4%
Dance	8%	MTSS - CES (2)	4%
WYSE	1.50%	Department Head Special Education	4%
Thespians (Head)	7%	Elementary Music	3%
Thespians (Assistant)	3%		
Scholastic Bowl - (Head)	7%	Special Services	
Skills USA	8%	Band Sup. (per event)	0.825%
Flags	3%	Summer School, Dr. Ed	0.09%
Dept. Head- Fine Arts/Vocational	4%	Formal Mentor (2 Years)	\$450
Dept. Head- English/Social Science	4%	Additional Clubs with Admin Approval	1.5%-3%
Dept. Head- Mathematics	4%	Assignable Duties- Calculated as percentages of the base	
Dept. Head- Science	4%	Bus Supervision (Excluding coaches for their sport)	
Dept. Head- PE/Driver's Ed/Health	4%	Under 30 Minutes radius	0.10%
Dept. Head- Special Education	4%	Over 30 Mile radius	0.12%
Dept. Head- Alternative Education	4%	Ticket Taker/seller	0.0825%
RTI (MTSS) 9-12	4%	Timer/Scorekeeper	0.0825%
		Crowd Control	0.0825%
		Concession Workers**	0.0825%
		Announcer, track meet helper, field event, timer, line clerk, clerk of course, scorekeep	0.0825%
		Mileage	IRS Rate

* High School & Junior High Concessions will be paid 10% of the base from the concession profits.

** For concessions: Pay adult workers, from concession profits, unless the adult worker is a sponsor of group/club working concessions then stipend will be paid to siad group, not worker.

E. LANE ADVANCEMENT

1. The Superintendent shall provide the staff with opportunities for the development of increased competence.
2. Credit for horizontal advancement on the salary schedule shall be given for coursework which meets one of the following criteria and approval of the Superintendent:
 - a. The course must be offered by an accredited institution of higher education.
 - b. The course must address the requirements to obtain a higher degree.
 - c. The course must be used to obtain certification, or an endorsement in another teaching area Examples; English as a Second Language (ESL), Reading Specialist, LBS 1, Math Specialist, foreign language, Teacher Leader.

All other college/university coursework requires prior approval by the Superintendent for horizontal advancement. The number of semester hours of credit to be allowed on the salary schedule will correspond to the number of semester hours of credit allowed by the college or university. Requests for credit shall be submitted in writing to the Superintendent's Administrative Assistant prior to the first class meeting. If the Superintendent determines that the class is only related to extracurricular activities, the teacher will be notified that no credit will be allowed on the salary schedule. Courses applicable to master's degree programs on file in the Unit Office need no prior approval.

3. Teachers may only move one (1) horizontal lane per school year, unless prior approval has been granted by the Superintendent (for example, moving from Lane BA-0 to BA-8. Teachers cannot move multiple lanes in the same school year; for example, moving from Lane BA-0 to BA-16).
4. All teachers will make every effort to continue professional growth.
5. Professional growth credit shall be confirmed upon receipt of evidence of successful completion of an activity or a passing grade for a college course.
6. Evidence of credit earned shall be submitted to the Unit Office by September 1. Successful completion of course(s) may be demonstrated through correspondence from instructor or department head when transcript is not available on September 1.

F. INSURANCE

The Board shall pay the employee's cost of group life and medical, vision, and dental insurance premiums for benefits recommended by the District 15 Insurance Committee and approved by the Association and the Board. Employees electing any coverage other than single coverage will pay the difference between the elected plan and the annual projected equivalence rate for single coverage. The Board shall maintain the insurance trust fund at the recommended level per projections by the agent.

Any insurance benefit changes shall be recommended by the Clinton Unit School District No. 15 insurance committee and approved by both the Association and the Board of Education. The insurance committee shall consist of the following voting members: eight (8) CEA members, two (2) non-certified employees, two (2) district administrators, and a board delegate.

The employee paid portion of the premium shall be converted under Premium Conversion Plan Section 125K of the Internal Revenue Code.

G. LONGEVITY/RETIREMENT

1. Longevity Bonus/Non-Retirement Incentive Payment

Certified staff will receive a one-time payment of longevity bonus upon reaching the following years of service to the Clinton CUSD#15 School District:

- a. Upon completion of 10 years of service, he/she would receive a \$500 bonus
- b. Upon completion of 15 years of service, he/she would receive a \$750 bonus
- c. Upon completion of 20 years of service he/she would receive a \$1000 bonus
- d. Upon completion of 25 years of service, he/she would receive a \$1500 bonus
- e. Upon completion of 30 years of service, he/she would receive a \$2000 bonus

2. Upon honorable separation from the school district, each teacher having completed twenty (20) years service to Clinton School District #15 shall receive a one-time lump sum payment of \$3,850 not to exceed a total raise of current law in their final year. At twenty five (25) completed years this sum shall increase to \$4,400 not to exceed a total raise of current law in their final year. Service in the Clinton District shall also include the years of experience an employee has brought to Clinton schools from a reorganization. A teacher who opts to receive the Retirement Incentive provided or in K-3 of this Article, is foreclosed from the benefits of this honorable separation paragraph.

3. Retirement Incentive Plan

a. Eligibility:

To be eligible for any of the following Plans, an employee must meet the following requirements:

- i. Be sixty (60) years of age by the last day of service in the District; or
- ii. Be at least fifty-five (55) years of age with thirty-five (35) years of creditable service as defined by the Illinois Teacher Retirement System by the last day of service in the District.
- iii. The teacher must have at least 15 years of service in the District by the last day of service in the District to be eligible.
- iv. The District may require proof of eligibility.

b. Definitions:

For purposes of this Article, nonexempt TRS creditable compensation (earnings) shall be defined by TRS rules and include (but are not limited to):

- Salary for regular contractual teaching duties
- Wages for substitute teaching
- Wages for homebound teaching or tutoring
- Earnings for extra duties performed that relate to teaching or supervision of students, and other assignments related to the academic program
- Earnings for summer school
- Bonuses
- Contributions to qualified plans eligible for tax-deferral under the Internal Revenue Code, Sections 401(a), 403(b), and 457(b)
- Contributions to flexible benefit plans
- Salary or back wage payments resulting from contract buy-outs, labor litigation, and settlement agreements

c. Plans:

One Year Plan

If an eligible employee gives the Board an irrevocable letter of retirement prior to June 1 stating that he/she shall retire at the end of the next school year, the employee will be removed from the salary schedule and for the final year of employment the employee's nonexempt TRS creditable earnings shall be increased to current law not to exceed by four percent (4%) over the employee's nonexempt TRS creditable earnings for the prior year of employment.

Example: The employee's prior year nonexempt TRS creditable earnings were \$40,000.00. The employee's final year nonexempt TRS creditable earnings will be \$41,600 (i.e., $\$40,000.00 \times 1.04 = \$41,600.00$).

Two Year Plan

If an eligible employee gives the Board an irrevocable letter of retirement prior to June 1 two (2) years prior to the year of retirement, the employee will be removed from the salary schedule and for the final two (2) years of employment the employee's nonexempt TRS creditable earnings shall be increased to current law not to exceed by four percent (4%) over the employee's nonexempt TRS creditable earnings for the prior years of employment respectively.

Example: An employee gives his/her irrevocable letter of retirement prior to June

1, 2025, stating he/she will retire June 30, 2027. The employee's nonexempt TRS creditable earnings for the 2024-2025 school year were \$40,000.00. The employee's nonexempt TRS creditable earnings for the 2025-2026 school year will be \$41,600.00 (i.e., $\$40,000.00 \times 1.04 = \$41,600.00$). The employee's nonexempt TRS creditable earnings for the 2026-2027 school year will be \$43,264.00 (i.e., $\$41,600.00 \times 1.04 = \$43,264.00$).

Three Year Plan

If an eligible employee gives the Board an irrevocable letter of retirement prior to June 1 three (3) years prior to the year of retirement, the employee will be removed from the salary schedule and for the final three (3) years of employment the employee's nonexempt TRS creditable earnings shall be increased to current law not to exceed by four percent (4%) over the employee's nonexempt TRS creditable earnings for the prior years of employment respectively.

Example: An employee gives his/her irrevocable letter of retirement prior to June 1, 2025, stating he/she will retire on June 30, 2028. The employee's nonexempt TRS creditable earnings for the 2024-2025 school year were \$40,000.00. The employee's nonexempt TRS creditable earnings for the 2025-2026 school year will be \$41,600.00 (i.e., $\$40,000.00 \times 1.04 = \$41,600.00$). The employee's nonexempt TRS creditable earnings for the 2026-2027 school year will be \$43,264.00 (i.e., $\$41,600.00 \times 1.04 = \$43,264.00$). The employee's nonexempt TRS creditable earnings for the 2027-2028 school year will be \$44,994.56 (i.e., $\$43,264.00 \times 1.04 = \$44,994.56$).

Four Year Plan

If an eligible employee gives the Board an irrevocable letter of retirement prior to June 1 four (4) years prior to the year of retirement, the employee will be removed from the salary schedule and for the final four (4) years of employment the employee's nonexempt TRS creditable earnings shall be increased to current law not to exceed by four percent (4) over the employee's nonexempt TRS creditable earnings for the prior years of employment respectively.

Example: An employee gives his/her irrevocable letter of retirement prior to June 1, 2025, stating he/she will retire on June 30, 2029. The employee's nonexempt TRS creditable earnings for the 2024-2025 school year were \$40,000.00. The employee's nonexempt TRS creditable earnings for the 2024-2025 school year will be \$41,600.00 (i.e., $\$40,000.00 \times 1.04 = \$41,600.00$). The employee's nonexempt TRS creditable earnings for the 2025-2026 school year will be \$43,264.00 (i.e., $\$41,600.00 \times 1.04 = \$43,264.00$). The employee's nonexempt TRS creditable earnings for the 2026-2027 school year will be \$44,994.56 (i.e., $\$43,264.00 \times 1.04 = \$44,994.56$). The employee's nonexempt TRS creditable earnings for the 2028-2029 school year will be \$46,794.34 (i.e., $\$44,994.56 \times 1.04 = \$46,794.34$).

Once an employee meets the threshold eligibility requirements as stated above, the employee must retire by the close of the school year that he/she first gains eligibility. The employee must submit his/her irrevocable letter of resignation/retirement to the Board of Education by June 1 of the school year prior to his/her retirement under the one (1) year plan, by June 1 two (2) years prior to his/her retirement under the two (2) year plan, by June 1 three (3) years prior to his/her retirement under the three (3) year plan, and by June

1 four (4) years prior to his/her retirement under the four (4) year plan. An employee who becomes eligible cannot defer eligibility to a future date. Eligibility occurs only once. Failure to retire at the close of the school year the employee first gains eligibility will forever foreclose the teacher from the benefits of this Retirement Incentive provision for the remainder of the employee's employment with the District.

d. Sick Leave

1. Teacher(s) who have completed twenty (20) years or more of service with the School District at the conclusion of the 2024-2025 school year have until August 18, 2025 to choose between the following two (2) options:

(a) If a letter of retirement is received by June 1 prior to the final four years prior to the final year of retirement, at the request of the teacher the teacher's accumulated sick leave will be increased on a one time basis to a total of three hundred twenty (320) days provided the teacher has at least fifty (50) days of accumulated sick leave. Beginning the 2025-2026 school year, the teacher will be entitled to ten (10) sick leave days each contract year.. These days will be added at the end of the school calendar year and before June 30th.

or

(b) The teacher does not receive the one-time basis increase in sick leave in subsection d.1 above, the teacher will be entitled to his/her annual normal allotment of sick leave pursuant to Article VIII of the contract.

The Teacher shall provide notice to the District in writing of which option no later than August 18, 2025.

2. Teachers who have completed nineteen (19) years or less of service with the School District at the conclusion of the 2024-2025 school year will be provided the following if a letter of retirement is received by June 1 prior to the final four years prior to the final year of retirement:

(a). Teacher(s) who have accumulated one hundred eighty (180) sick leave days or more at the time he/she submits the letter of retirement shall be provided an one time additional grant of sick leave days equal to no more than a total of three hundred (300) sick leave days (i.e. if the teacher has 220 accumulated sick leave days, the District shall provide 80 sick leave days to equal 300 accumulated sick leave days).

d. Extra Duties

Once an irrevocable letter of retirement is submitted, the employee will not be assigned any additional extra-duties or TRS reportable duties not currently being performed without the consent of the employee.

If after submitting an irrevocable letter of retirement, the employee resigns from, is removed from or does not perform duties for which the employee was compensated the previous year (i.e., Schedule B, extended contract and/or stipends), the employee's nonexempt TRS creditable earnings will be adjusted accordingly.

Example: The employee's nonexempt TRS creditable earnings from the 2022-2023 school year were \$43,000.00, of which \$3,000.00 was compensation for coaching basketball in 2019-2020. Under the employee's retirement plan, he/she would be scheduled to receive \$44,720.00 nonexempt TRS creditable earnings for the 2023-2024 school year (i.e., $\$43,000.00 \times 1.04 = \$44,720.00$). However, the employee resigns from his/her coaching position before the start of the 2023-2024 school year. The employee's nonexempt TRS creditable earnings for the 2023-2024 school year will be \$41,600.00 (i.e., $\$40,000.00 \times 1.04 = \$41,600.00$) rather than \$44,720.00.

e. Revocation/Legislation

In the event an employee has submitted his/her timely irrevocable letter of retirement but fails to meet the eligibility requirements because of illness or life changing circumstances, the Board, in its sole discretion, may allow the employee to rescind his/her letter of retirement, provided the employee returns to the Board any nonexempt TRS creditable earnings paid to the employee in excess of the amount the employee would otherwise have received under the salary schedule for such year(s) in which the creditable earnings were paid.

If legislation is enacted and/or administrative rules are adopted during the life of this agreement that result in a greater cost to the District than the costs generated by this agreement, the provisions relating to such benefits shall be null and void.

f. Limitation on TRS Nonexempt Creditable Compensation

When an employee has thirty (30) years of TRS creditable service, the employee's nonexempt creditable TRS earnings, irrespective of form and no matter how arising, and whether or not arising under this collective bargaining agreement, shall not exceed the amounts specified hereinafter.

No employee's nonexempt creditable TRS earnings shall increase from one school year to the next by more than current law but not to exceed 4% or be otherwise increased so as to create liability on the part of the Board or District for any portion of an employee's retirement annuity, or result in any District or Board-paid penalty or fee to TRS.

Teachers who are already at the top of their respective salary lanes on the salary schedule and who submit evidence of successful course completion from a college or university (per K.2 of the Agreement), are eligible to move to the next salary lane(s) at the highest step applicable to their actual years of documented teaching.

H. TUITION REIMBURSEMENT

The Board will reimburse bargaining unit members who present an official university grade sheet for a B or better grade in classes according to the following regulations:

- a. Each course including on-line courses must be approved by the Superintendent prior to the first day class meeting.
- b. Each course must be directly related to the employee's assignment or in an education related graduate degree program or for certification in another teaching area.

- c. Each course shall be from any university approved by the Illinois State Board of Education.
- d. Reimbursement shall be up to \$1800 per fiscal year. Tuition waivers will not be considered as part of any tuition reimbursement. Teachers who use tuition waivers to offset the cost of tuition will only be reimbursed their actual out of pocket tuition cost for any course taken.
- e. There shall be no reimbursement for classes that have no tuition or fee costs to the employee.
- f. The employee will be responsible for notifying the Superintendent's Administrative Assistant of the completion of coursework within thirty (30) days of its completion.
- g. The Board shall reimburse the employees within forty-five (45) days after receipt of the request for reimbursement and the attached grade sheets.

ARTICLE XV
CALENDAR

Illinois School Code (105 ILCS 5/10-20.56) allows for adoption of an eLearning program in lieu of utilizing the District's scheduled emergency days. CUSD15 will design and adopt an eLearning program that would allow for a shift to e-learning that shall permit student instruction to be received electronically while students are not physically present in lieu of the District's scheduled emergency days. Per ISBE guidelines only five (5) of these days can be used during a school year, any emergency days beyond that would simply result in a canceled school day.

Per 105 ILCS 5/10-20.56 guidelines this program must be adopted for three years at a time. Therefore, an adoption of a new e-learning program would be in effect for the 2025-2026, 2026-2027, and 2027-2028 school years, pending approval from ISBE.

ARTICLE XVI
PROFESSIONAL GRIEVANCE PROCEDURE

- A. Definition A grievance can be any claim by a teacher or the Association that there has been a violation, misinterpretation or misapplication of the terms of this agreement. This does not prevent a teacher from discussing any policy or practice, not included in this agreement, with the administration.
- B. Purpose The primary purpose of this procedure is to secure, at the lowest level possible, an equitable solution to the problems of the parties. A grievance may be filed by an individual teacher, a group of teachers, or the Association.
- C. Procedure All grievance proceedings, but not necessarily the grievance itself shall be informal, as is mutually agreeable. Records shall be kept by all parties to the grievance. The number of days indicated at each step shall be considered the maximum allowable to all parties, and every effort shall be made to expedite the proceedings. Claimants having a grievance must follow these steps:
- Step 1: Any claim shall first be presented orally by the claimant to the most immediate administrator. If requested by the grievant, an Association representative shall be present to assist in oral resolution of the difference.
- Step 2: If a satisfactory solution of the claim is not reached orally, a written statement (see attached form) must be filed by the claimant or Association within ten (10) business days. The formal grievance and the administrator's reply shall be in writing.
- a. In stating his/her grievance, the claimant or Association must specify the violation and give pertinent evidence in support of his/her grievance.
- b. The grievance shall be signed by the claimant and presented to the most immediate administrator.
- c. The administrator shall, within ten (10) business days of the receipt of the written grievance, arrange a meeting between the claimant, an Association representative and himself/herself. The administrator shall have ten (10) business days to reply in writing his/her decision on the grievance. The answer shall include reasons for the decision. The grievance shall be regarded as settled and closed within ten (10) business days after the meeting, if an appeal has not been filed. The grievance claim shall be submitted to the immediate supervisor within thirty (30) business days of the alleged violation or the claimant's discovery of the alleged violation.
- Step 3: If a grievance is not resolved in Steps 1 and 2, then the claimant or Association may file a written appeal within fifteen (15) business days after the meeting in Step 2 to the Superintendent or his/her official designee. The Superintendent shall arrange a meeting between himself herself, claimant and Association representative within ten (10) school business days. The Superintendent shall give a written reply to the claimant within ten (10) business days. The claimant will then have ten (10) business days to appeal the decision in writing. If no appeal is made within ten (10) business days or fifteen (15) business days after the meeting with the Superintendent, then the case shall be considered closed.
- Step 4: If the grievance is not resolved at Step 3 within the time limits provided, the grievance may be heard by the Board at its option. The President of the Board shall arrange for a meeting

to take place with representatives of the Association within ten (10) business days of his/her receipt of the appeal. Each party shall have the right to include in its representation such witnesses and counselors as it deems necessary to develop pertinent facts to the grievance. Upon conclusion of the hearing, the President of the Board shall have ten (10) business days in which to provide a written decision with reasons to the grievant and the Association.

- Step 5: If the Association is not satisfied with the disposition of the grievance at Steps 2, 3, and 4, or the time limits expire without the issuance of the Superintendent's and the Board President's written reply, (or if the Board elects not to hear the grievance), the Association may submit the grievance to final and binding arbitration under the Voluntary Labor Arbitration Rules of the American Arbitration Association. The AAA or the Federal Mediation and Conciliation Service shall act as administrator of the proceedings. If a demand for arbitration is not filed within thirty (30) business days of the date for the Board's written reply, or from the date of the meeting if no reply is received, then the grievances shall be deemed withdrawn.
- a. Neither the Board nor the Association shall be permitted to assert any grounds or evidence before the arbitrator which was not previously disclosed to the other party.
 - b. The arbitrator shall have no power to alter the terms of this agreement.
 - c. The arbitrator is empowered to include in any recommendations such final reimbursements or other remedies as he/she judges to be proper.
 - d. Each party shall bear the full costs for its representation in the arbitration. The cost of the arbitrator and the AAA shall be divided equally between the parties.
 - e. If either party requests a transcript of the proceedings, that party shall bear the full costs for that transcript. If both parties order a transcript, the cost of the two (2) transcripts shall be divided equally between the parties.
- D. If the Association and the Superintendent agree, Step 1 and/or Step 2 of the grievance procedure may be bypassed and the grievance brought directly to the next step.
- E. Grievances involving one or more teachers or one or more supervisors and grievances involving an administrator above the building level may be initially filed by the Association at Step 3.
- F. The Board acknowledges the right of an Association representative to participate, at the request of the grievant, in the processing of a grievance at any level and no teacher shall be required to discuss any grievance if an Association representative is not present.
- G. When a grievant is not represented by the Association, on its request the Association shall have the right to have its representative present to state its views at all stages of the grievance procedure.
- H. The Board and the administration shall cooperate with the Association in its investigation of any grievance, and further they shall furnish the Association with such information, with the exception of the personal file, requested for the processing of any grievance.
- I. No reprisals of any kind shall be taken by the Board or the Administration against a teacher because of the teacher's participation in this grievance procedure. Conversely, no reprisals of any kind shall be taken by the Association and/or grievant against an administrator or Board member for the

administrator's or Board member's participation in the grievance procedure.

- J. Should the investigation or processing of any grievance require that a teacher be absent from his/her regular assignment, he/she shall be released under the provisions of personal leave. If any Association representative accompanies the teacher, the representative shall not be charged personal leave, and the Association will assume the cost of the Association representative's substitute. The teachers involved shall notify the building principal the day before they expect to be absent from the classroom.
- K. All documents, communications, and records dealing with the processing of a grievance shall be filed separately from the personnel files of the participants.
- L. A grievance may be withdrawn at any level without establishing precedent.

ARTICLE XVII
LEGALITY OF AGREEMENT

- A. Savings Clause: Any portion of this agreement not in violation of any law of the state of Illinois is legally binding on both the Association and the Board. Should any article, section, or clause of this agreement be declared illegal by a court of competent jurisdiction, then that article, section, or clause shall be deleted from this agreement to the extent that it violates the law. The remaining articles, sections, and clauses shall remain in full force and effect.
- B. Complete Understanding: The terms and conditions set forth in this Agreement represent the full and complete understanding between the parties. The terms and conditions may be modified only through the written mutual consent of the parties.

ARTICLE XVIII
NO STRIKE CLAUSE

During the terms of this agreement, neither the Association or individual teacher shall participate in a strike in whole or in part.

ARTICLE XIX
DURATION AND ACCEPTANCE OF AGREEMENT

- A. This Agreement shall be effective August 15, 2025, and shall continue in effect through August 2027. This Agreement shall expire on the date indicated.

The parties hereby drop all proposals upon which no agreement was reached and conclude bargaining on a successor document to the 2025-2027 Agreement.

In witness thereof:

For The Clinton Education
Association

For The Board of Education
School District No. 15

Nathan Wheeler, President

Dan Matthews, President

Katy Arnold, Negotiations Chairperson

Sondra Baker, Secretary

FORM FOR FILING OF GRIEVANCE

Name of Complainant	Date of Filing
Home Address	Home Telephone
Number of years in school system	Name and Address of School
Position Currently Held	Principal
School Telephone	Grievance Representative
Provision of Master Contract or School Policy Allegedly Violated	
Statement of Grievance:	
Action Requested:	